



ORTING JUNIOR WRESTLING WRESTLE- OFF & ROSTER SELECTION POLICY

1. Purpose

The purpose of the Orting Junior Wrestling Wrestle-Off & Roster Selection Policy is to establish a **fair, consistent, competitive, and transparent process** for determining Varsity and Junior Varsity roster placement within each weight class.

OJW believes roster placement should be determined through competition whenever multiple wrestlers are competing for the available Varsity and Junior Varsity positions.

The wrestle-off process is intended to provide every eligible athlete with a fair opportunity to earn their position **on the mat**, using the same published procedures and expectations for all participating wrestlers.



2. Roster Designations

Within each weight class, wrestlers may be designated as:

Varsity (V) — the #1 wrestler within the weight class.

Junior Varsity (JV) — the #2 wrestler within the weight class.

Exhibition — additional wrestlers within the weight class who are not designated Varsity or Junior Varsity.

Only **two wrestlers per weight class — Varsity and Junior Varsity — may represent OJW in the PCJWL postseason tournament series.**

Exhibition wrestlers do not advance into the PCJWL postseason tournament series.

However, Exhibition wrestlers remain members of OJW and may continue participating in regular Monday and Wednesday team practices through the team's Washington Folkstyle State preparation period in February.

3. Wrestle-Off Period

OJW will establish a designated **Wrestle-Off Period** each season.

Specific dates may vary from year to year based upon the practice calendar, tournament schedule, league requirements, and other season considerations.

Formal wrestle-offs will generally occur **concurrently with normal team practices** in a designated wrestle-off area.

Normal team instruction will continue while wrestle-offs are being conducted. Wrestlers participating in a scheduled wrestle-off will leave their instructional group when called and return to normal practice following completion of their wrestle-off responsibilities.

The season-specific wrestle-off dates and matchups will be communicated separately through the annual **OJW Wrestle-Off Schedule**.



4. Establishing the Wrestle-Off Field

Individual wrestle-off matchups cannot be finalized until OJW has sufficient information regarding:

- Athlete registration and participation;
- Applicable weight classes;
- Prior Round Robin weigh-ins; and
- The number of wrestlers competing within each weight class.

Registration information and official weights recorded during preceding Round Robin tournaments will be used to establish the appropriate weight class for wrestle-off competition.

Once the wrestle-off field has been established, OJW will publish a season-specific Wrestle-Off Schedule identifying participating athletes, weight classes, scheduled dates, and approximate match times.

5. Wrestle-Off Format

The wrestle-off format will be determined by the number of wrestlers competing within an individual weight class.

One Wrestler

When only one eligible wrestler occupies a weight class, no wrestle-off is required.

That wrestler will be designated **Varsity** for that weight class.

Two Wrestlers

When two wrestlers occupy a weight class, the wrestlers will compete in a **head-to-head match**.

The winner will be designated **Varsity**.

The other wrestler will be designated **Junior Varsity**.

Three Wrestlers

When three wrestlers occupy a weight class, the wrestlers will compete in a **Round Robin** format.

Each wrestler will compete against each of the other wrestlers.

Final placement will establish:

1st — Varsity

2nd — Junior Varsity

3rd — Exhibition

If all three wrestlers finish the Round Robin with a **1-1 record**, the wrestlers will compete again to determine final placement rather than having placement determined through subjective criteria.

Four or More Wrestlers

When four or more wrestlers occupy a weight class, OJW will conduct a **coach-seeded bracket**.

Bracket results will determine final placement, including the Varsity and Junior Varsity positions.

Remaining wrestlers will be designated Exhibition.



6. Bracket Seeding

For weight classes requiring a bracket, the OJW coaching staff will seed the initial bracket.

Coaches may consider:

- Prior Round Robin results;
- Head-to-head results;
- Demonstrated current-season performance; and
- Relevant competition history.

The purpose of seeding is to create an appropriate initial competition bracket.

Seeding does not determine roster placement.

Once competition begins, final Varsity and Junior Varsity placement will be determined by the wrestle-off results.

Coaches seed the competition. Wrestlers determine the outcome on the mat.

7. Match Rules

All official OJW wrestle-off matches will follow applicable **PCJWL match rules and match lengths**.

Wrestle-offs will be conducted as organized competition and will include a designated referee and scorer/table worker.

The referee will control the match and enforce applicable competition rules in the same manner expected during league competition.

8. Wrestle-Off Area

OJW will establish a designated mat area for wrestle-off competition.

Only the following individuals may be within the designated wrestle-off area during competition:

- Participating wrestlers;
- OJW Coaches;
- Assigned referee;
- Assigned scorer/table personnel; and
- Other team personnel specifically assigned to administer the wrestle-off.

Parents and spectators must remain in the designated spectator or stands area.

Parents and spectators may not enter, gather around, coach from, or otherwise approach the designated wrestle-off area.

Wrestle-offs are **team-administered competitions**, and participating athletes will be coached and managed by the OJW coaching staff.

This requirement is intended to provide athletes with a fair, organized, consistent, and distraction-free competitive environment.



9. Missed Wrestle-Offs

Wrestlers are expected to participate in their scheduled wrestle-off.

A wrestler who is unable to participate in their originally scheduled wrestle-off will be provided **one make-up opportunity**.

The make-up match will be scheduled by the OJW coaching staff within the established Wrestle-Off Period whenever reasonably possible.

If the wrestler also misses the scheduled make-up opportunity, the wrestler will **forfeit that wrestle-off opportunity**, unless an extraordinary circumstance prevented participation.

Extraordinary circumstances are limited to situations outside the athlete's reasonable control and are not intended to provide additional opportunities for routine scheduling conflicts or unexcused absences.

10. Finality of Wrestle-Off Results

Once the wrestle-off process for a weight class has been completed and final placement has been established, the results are **final for the season**.

OJW will not conduct subsequent challenge matches during the season for the purpose of replacing an established Varsity or Junior Varsity wrestler.

This provides roster stability and allows wrestlers and Coaches to transition from roster selection to continued athlete development and competition preparation.

11. No Coaching Override

OJW Coaches will **not override completed wrestle-off results** to alter Varsity or Junior Varsity placement.

Coaches are responsible for:

- Administering the wrestle-off process;
- Establishing brackets and seeding when necessary;
- Providing appropriate officiating and scoring;
- Maintaining a safe and organized competitive environment; and
- Ensuring the published wrestle-off procedures are applied consistently.

Coaching staff preference, projected tournament performance, or other subjective considerations will not be used to replace the Varsity or Junior Varsity wrestler established through the completed wrestle-off process.



12. Varsity & Junior Varsity Practice Expectations

Once Varsity and Junior Varsity rosters have been established, wrestlers occupying those positions are expected to participate in OJW's **Friday Advanced/Competition practices**, in addition to regular Monday and Wednesday team practices.

Friday practices are an important component of Varsity and Junior Varsity preparation and may include:

- Advanced technical instruction;
- Situational wrestling;
- Chain wrestling;
- Live wrestling;
- Match strategy;
- Competition preparation; and
- Postseason preparation.

Varsity and Junior Varsity wrestlers are expected to attend Friday practices unless they are unable to participate due to **illness or another excused absence**.

13. Exhibition Wrestlers

Exhibition designation does not end an athlete's season or participation with OJW.

Exhibition wrestlers remain members of the team and are encouraged to continue developing throughout the remainder of the season.

Although Exhibition wrestlers do not participate in the PCJWL postseason tournament series, they may continue participating in regular **Monday and Wednesday OJW practices through the Washington Folkstyle State preparation period in February**.

OJW's goal is continued athlete development regardless of roster designation.

14. Annual Wrestle-Off Schedule

This policy is intended to remain consistent from season to season.

Because practice dates, tournament dates, registration numbers, weight-class participation, and other scheduling considerations may change annually, **specific wrestle-off dates will not be established within this standing policy**.

Instead, OJW will publish a separate season-specific:

OJW WRESTLE-OFF SCHEDULE



The annual schedule may include:

- Official Wrestle-Off Period;
- Weight class;
- Participating wrestlers;
- Competition format;
- Match date;
- Approximate match time;
- Bracket or Round Robin information, when applicable; and
- Make-up scheduling information.

The annual Wrestle-Off Schedule will be communicated to participating families once athlete participation and weight-class distribution are sufficiently established.

15. Fairness & Consistency

OJW is committed to administering wrestle-offs in a manner that is **fair, consistent, organized, and transparent**.

The same published procedures will apply to all participating wrestlers.

Roster positions are earned through the established wrestle-off process, and the coaching staff is responsible for protecting the integrity of that process.

The purpose of wrestle-offs is not to divide the team, but to fairly determine the limited roster positions required for league competition while continuing to support the development of **every OJW wrestler**.